

5.3 Selecting Sound Cards



A high-end sound card

The best part about a computer is that you can convert it into an entertainment centre. You can not only watch movies but also play games and listen to music. Although this requires a lot of system resources, if your computer has what it takes then it can be done.

Largely, users are satisfied with the standard speakers that come with the PC, however for an enthralling experience you will need more than the two forlorn stubs sitting on your desk. Listening to music doesn't demand much out of a computer, and the most widely used audio source is the stereo. If you listen to music alone, you can still make do with a standard set of speakers. But if you love to watch movies on your PC, a 5.1 setup would do you a lot of good.

Newer computers almost always have a 5.1 sound card chip onboard that does a pretty good job of providing sound but also hogs system resources. Another drawback to such solutions is that